

AGENCY CASE STUDY

VELOCITY SPORTS DRINK

'No Limits' — Digital-First Launch Campaign

Client:	Velocity Energy Beverages LLC	Campaign ID:	VEL-2024-001
Industry:	Sports & Energy Beverages	Status:	Completed
Duration:	January – March 2024 (12 weeks)	Budget:	\$320,000 USD
Prepared by:	Digital & Performance Division	Confidential:	Yes – Internal Only

Executive Summary

Velocity Energy Beverages engaged the agency to launch their new isotonic sports drink in the UAE, KSA, and Kuwait markets simultaneously. The product was entering a highly competitive category dominated by Gatorade (46% market share) and Powerade (28% market share). The 'No Limits' campaign positioned Velocity as the authentic choice for everyday athletes rather than professional sports stars.

The campaign achieved 14.2 million total impressions in 12 weeks, generated 8,400 retail stocking requests across GCC, and drove Velocity to 7% market share in UAE within 6 months of launch — significantly ahead of the 3% first-year target.

Market Context & Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Market Share (UAE)	Price Point	Key Message	Weakness
Gatorade	46%	AED 8–12	Sports performance	Perceived as sugary
Powerade	28%	AED 7–10	Hydration	Generic, low trust
Lucozade Sport	11%	AED 10–14	British heritage	Low local relevance
Velocity (new)	0%	AED 9–13	Everyday athletes	Zero awareness

Creative Strategy

The central insight driving the 'No Limits' strategy was that existing sports drink advertising only spoke to elite athletes — runners finishing marathons, players scoring match-winning goals. Research

showed that 74% of sports drink consumers in the UAE are 'everyday exercisers': people who go to the gym 3-4 times a week, play weekend football, or cycle in the morning before work. Velocity was positioned as THEIR drink.

The visual language was deliberately raw and kinetic: shot on iPhone and mirrorless cameras, high contrast color grading, fast cuts, and real people — not models. All talent was sourced from actual UAE gym communities and amateur sports leagues.

Channel Strategy

Channel	Role	Budget	Primary Metric
TikTok (Organic + Paid)	Awareness + Virality	\$85,000	Views, Shares
Instagram Reels + Stories	Consideration	\$75,000	Profile Visits, Link Clicks
Snapchat	Awareness (KSA/Kuwait focus)	\$40,000	Swipe-Ups
YouTube Pre-Roll (6s + 15s)	Brand recall	\$50,000	View Rate, Recall Lift
Google Search	Capture demand	\$25,000	Clicks, Conversions
Gym Network OOH (Dubai/AUH)	Physical presence	\$30,000	Footfall uplift
Influencer (12 micro, 2 macro)	Credibility + Reach	\$15,000	EMV, Engagement

Key Results

Metric	Target	Actual	Delta
Total Campaign Impressions	10,000,000	14,200,000	+42%
TikTok Organic Views (best video)	500,000	2,100,000	+320%
Instagram Story Swipe-Up Rate	3%	5.8%	+93%
Retail Stock Requests (GCC)	5,000	8,400	+68%
UAE Market Share (6 months)	3%	7%	+133%
Brand Awareness (UAE, target demo)	15%	34%	+127%
Cost Per Acquisition (DTC)	AED 45	AED 28	-38% (better)
Overall Campaign ROAS	1.8x	3.1x	+72%

Key Learnings

TikTok is the new TV for beverage launches:	The top-performing TikTok video (a 23-second unscripted clip of a footballer training at 5am) generated 2.1M organic views with zero paid amplification, reaching our target audience more efficiently than any paid channel.
Gym OOH drives online search:	During the 6 weeks of gym network OOH, branded search volume increased by 188% in Dubai and Abu Dhabi, demonstrating strong offline-to-online attribution for this category.
Amateur athlete UGC is gold:	The #VelocityNoLimits challenge generated 1,400 pieces of organic UGC. The top 20 UGC videos outperformed all agency-produced content in engagement rate by an average of 3.4x.
Snapchat underperformed in UAE:	Despite strong Snapchat penetration in KSA and Kuwait, UAE performance was below benchmark. Future GCC campaigns should weight Snapchat budget toward KSA only.